



# COMMON CHORES

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First thing in the morning, many people wake up to the sound of their alarm clock. They **roll out of bed**, stretch, and maybe **brush up** on the news while they **whip up** some breakfast. If  
5 they're running late, they might just **grab** a coffee and **munch on** a granola bar.

Once they **get through** breakfast, it's time to **tackle** the chores. Doing the dishes isn't just about cleaning; it's about **clearing out** the clutter  
10 from the sink. You'll hear someone say, "I need to **get around to** washing these dishes," if they've been procrastinating.

For laundry, Americans often say they need to **throw in** a load. Once the washing machine is  
15 done, you **hang up** or **toss into** the dryer the clothes. Folding laundry is another task where you might hear, "I'll **get to it** later."

Cleaning the house involves a lot of phrasal verbs too. You might **dust off** the furniture, **sweep up** or **vacuum up** the floors, and **wipe down** the counters. If there's a mess, you'll need to **clean up** after yourself or your pets.

Afternoons might be when people **drop by** the grocery store to pick up some essentials or **run errands**. If you hear someone say they're "just **popping out**," they're likely heading out for something quick.

Evening time brings its own set of activities. Maybe you'll settle down to watch some TV, or **catch up** on emails, or even **tackle** some work from home. Cooking dinner is a big deal for some, where you might **heat up** leftovers or **cook up** something new.

Before bed, it's common to **wind down** by reading or just **chilling out**. You'll **turn off** the lights, **shut down** the computer, and **get ready for** bed, which might involve **washing up** or **brushing off** the day's dust.

Remember, if you **fall behind** on your  
40 chores, don't stress; just try to **catch up** over the  
weekend or whenever you have some spare time.  
And if someone offers to **help out**, **take them up**  
on it!